



AND WE'LL BUY OURSELVES A LITTLE PIECE OF HEAVEN

ALI: FEAR EATS THE SOUL / 1974

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

New German Cinema

DIRECTOR

Rainer Werner Fassbinder

WRITER

Rainer Werner Fassbinder

STARS

Brigitte Mira, El Hedi ben Salem, Barbara Valentin, Irm Hermann

BEFORE

1955 Douglas Sirk's romantic melodrama *All That Heaven Allows* provides inspiration for Fassbinder's *Ali*.

1972 Fassbinder makes his mark as a provocative filmmaker with *The Bitter Tears of Petra von Kant*.

AFTER

1979 *The Marriage of Maria Braun* is Fassbinder's biggest mainstream success.

1980 Fassbinder's TV mini-series *Berlin Alexanderplatz* becomes a cult classic.



Rainer Werner Fassbinder's *Ali: Fear Eats the Soul* (*Angst essen Seele auf*) is an intense study of an unlikely but tender relationship between an aging German cleaning woman and a younger Arab immigrant worker. It is also a trenchant commentary on the state of 1970s Germany, as the couple face the derision and criticism of their family and friends. By focusing on the relationship between a white German woman and an immigrant, and placing it in the tough urban heart of Munich, Fassbinder

Fassbinder (left) plays Eugen, son-in-law of German cleaning woman Emmi (center). He and his wife Krista (Irm Hermann) laugh at Emmi when she says she has fallen in love with a younger Moroccan man.

achieved the emotional engagement of classic melodrama while exposing the underlying tensions in German culture.

New German Cinema directors such as Fassbinder sought to create something peculiarly German by bringing together the sharp modernity and realism of the French and British new waves with the